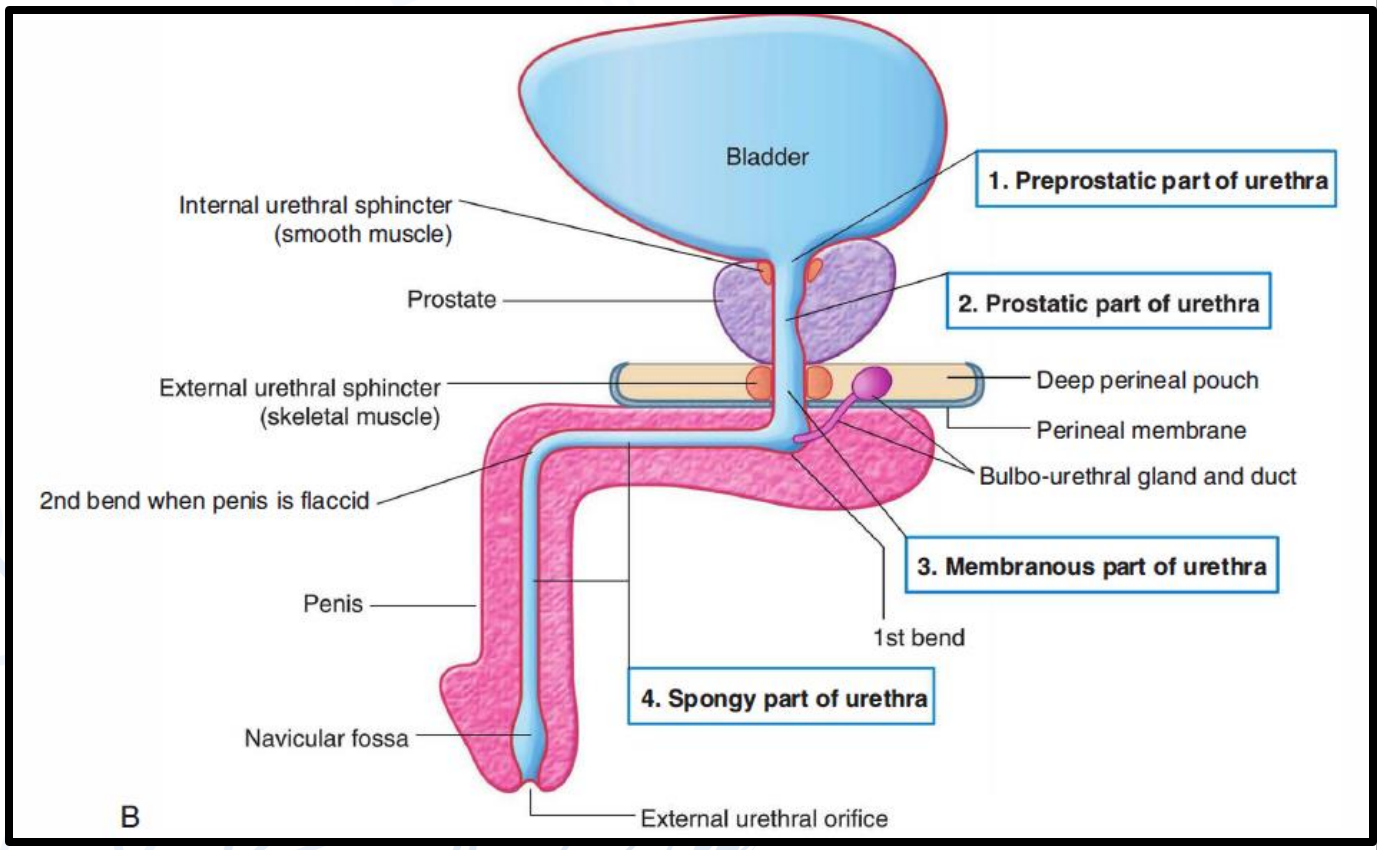
Urethra

- It is the duct that transmits urine from the urinary bladder outside the body.
- It arises from the lower end (neck) of the urinary bladder. It transmits urine and semen (in males).

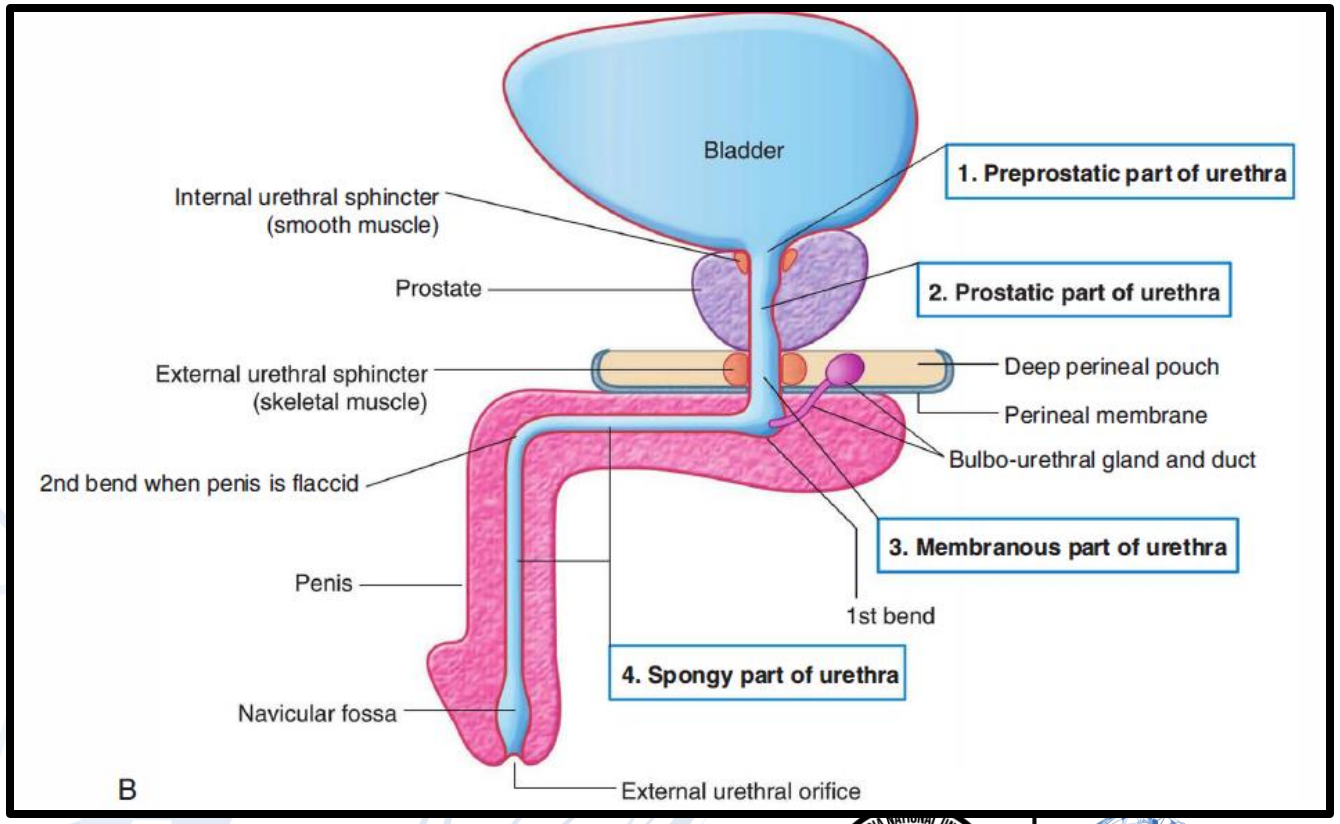


ANU MEDICAL SCHOOL PROGRAM

Male Urethra

- It is about 20 cm long. It is longer than the female urethra and has 4 parts :

1- Intramural part : it lies within the lower end of the urinary bladder and is surrounded by the internal urethral sphincter.



ANU MEDICAL SCHOOL PROGRAM

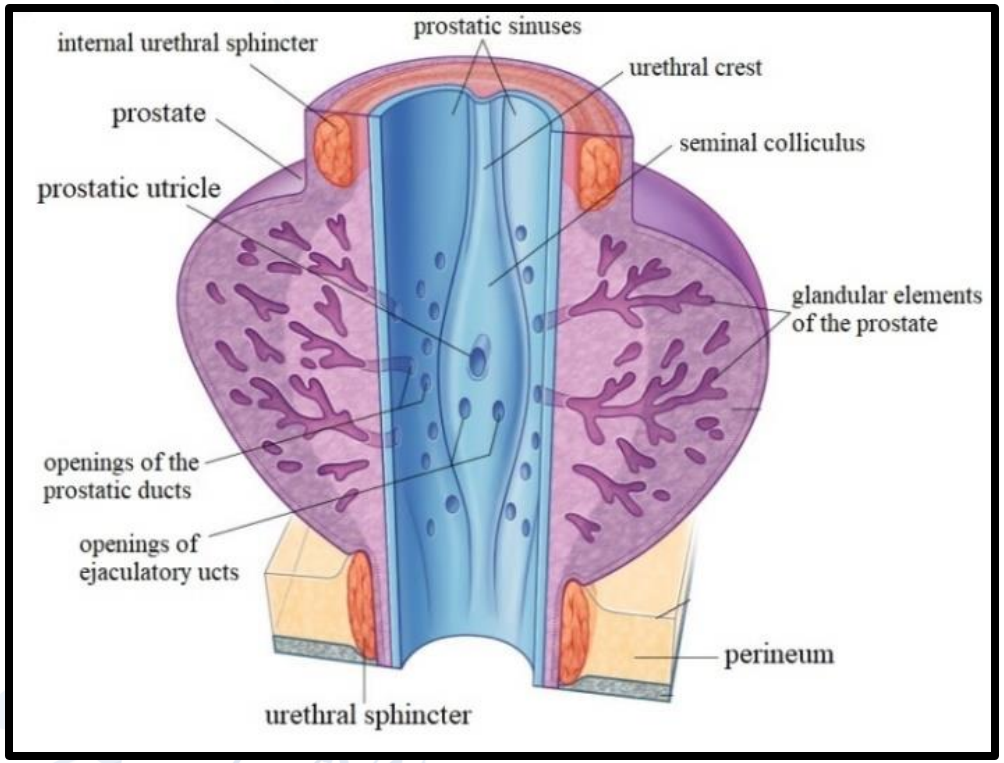
Male Urethra

2- Prostatic part : the ***widest and most dilatable part*** of the urethra. Its posterior wall shows:

Urethral crest: a midline longitudinal ridge.

Seminal colliculus: an elevation on the middle of the urethral crest.

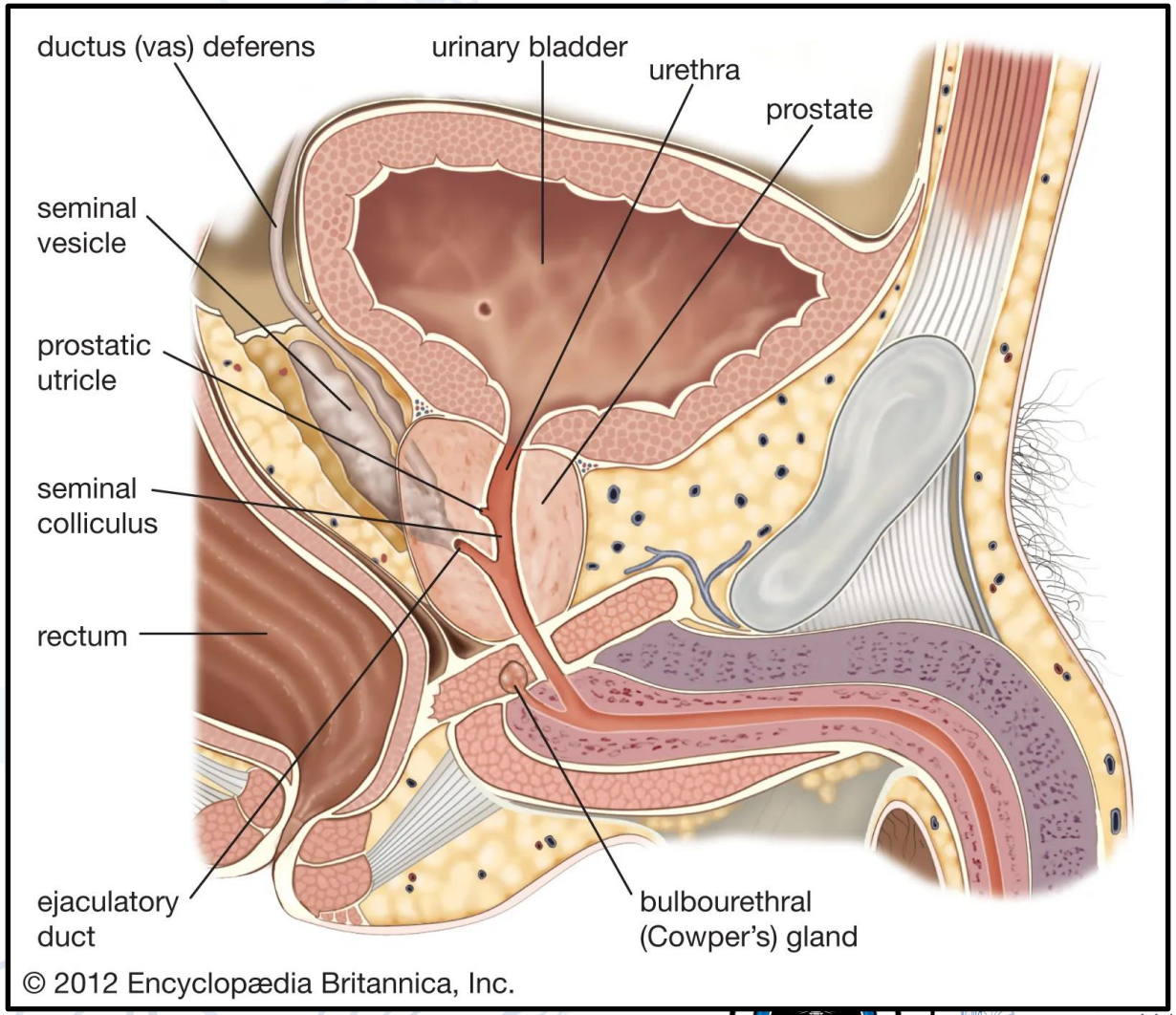
Prostatic sinus on each side of the crest where the prostatic ducts open.



ANU MEDICAL SCHOOL PROGRAM

Male Urethra

Prostatic utricle (homologue of the uterus in women) is a blind pouch that opens in the center of the seminal colliculus. On each side of the utricle, an ejaculatory duct opens.

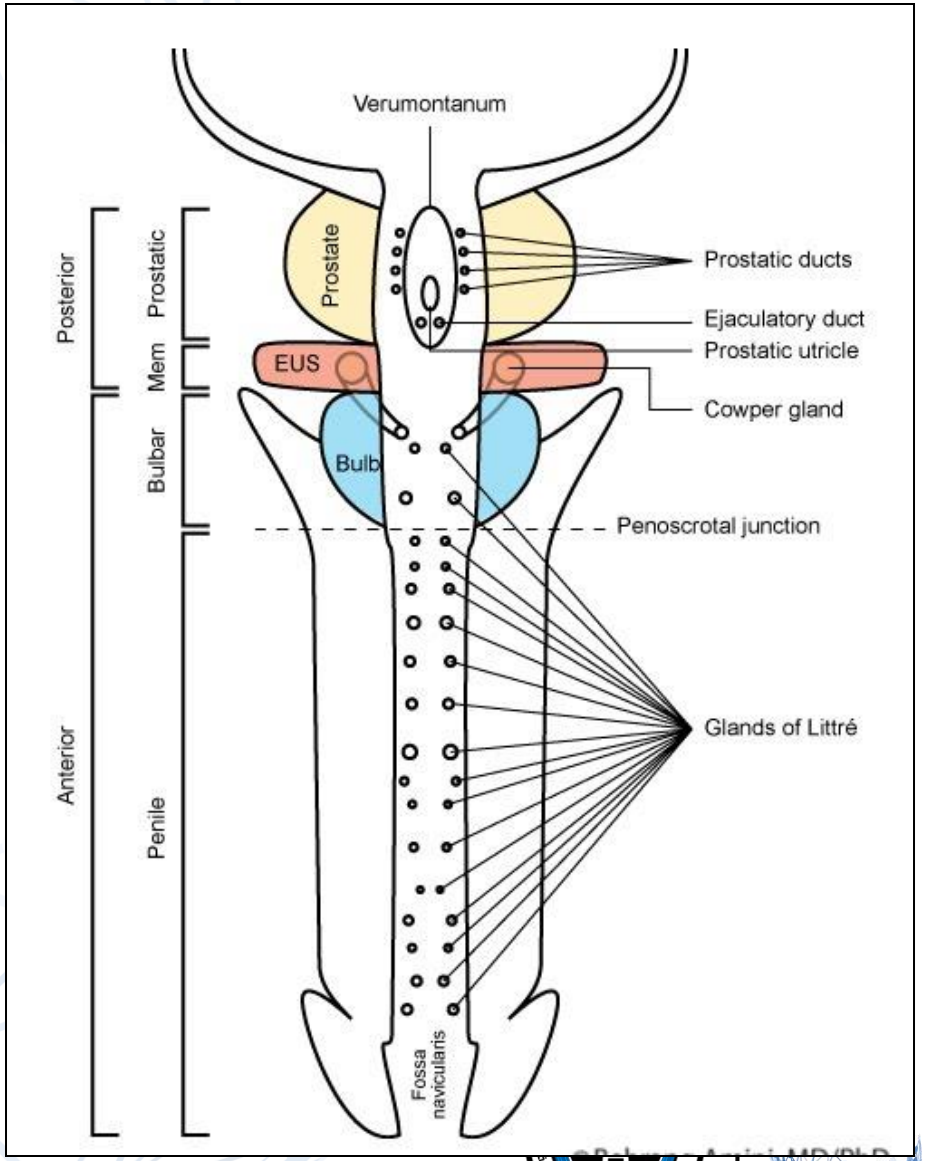


ANU MEDICAL SCHOOL PROGRAM

Male Urethra

3- Membranous part : lies in the deep perineal pouch and is surrounded by the external urethral sphincter. It is the ***shortest*** and ***least dilatable*** part of the urethra.

4- Penile (spongy) part : the ***longest part*** of the urethra that passes through the bulb of the penis then the corpus spongiosum and ends at the ***external urethral meatus*** (narrowest point of the urethra). Before the external opening, it shows a dilatation called ***navicular fossa***. The ducts of the bulbourethral glands open in the penile urethra.



ANU MEDICAL SCHOOL PROGRAM